FREE MINI GUIDE

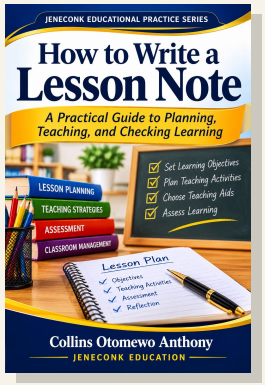
JENECONK EDUCATIONAL RESOURCES

7 ESSENTIAL COMPONENTS OF A GOOD LESSON NOTE

A Practical Introduction for Teachers and Student Teachers

PREPARE BETTER | TEACH WITH PURPOSE | CHECK LEARNING

A concise guide to the key areas that help teachers plan purposeful, organised and assessable lessons.



Companion to the complete guide, How to Write a Lesson Note

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THE FOUNDATION

Why a Good Lesson Note Matters

Effective teaching begins before a teacher enters the classroom. A lesson note is an organised plan for a particular lesson. It helps the teacher decide what learners should achieve, what resources and activities will support learning, how the lesson will progress and how understanding will be checked.

A useful lesson note helps you answer five questions:

WHAT
What should learners know or be able to do?

HOW
How will the content be taught and practised?

WITH WHAT
Which materials and resources are needed?

WHO
What will the teacher and learners each do?

HOW WILL I KNOW?
What evidence will show that learning has taken place?

The seven essential components

Schools and education authorities may arrange lesson-note fields differently. The seven areas below describe useful functions of lesson preparation; they are not a compulsory universal template. Always follow the format required by your school or institution.

1. Class information
Identify the school, subject, class or grade, date, term, week and lesson duration, as required by the school's format.

2. Topic and sub-topic
State the main subject matter and narrow it to the particular aspect to be taught. Example: Basic Science — Plants — Parts of a Plant.

3. Instructional objectives
Describe what learners should demonstrate by the end of the lesson. Use observable verbs such as identify, explain, compare, calculate or construct.

4. Instructional materials
List suitable resources that support explanation, demonstration or learner practice.

5. Previous knowledge
Identify relevant knowledge or experience learners already have and use it as a bridge to the new lesson.

6. Lesson presentation / teaching and learning activities
Plan the sequence of teaching, learner participation, practice, reinforcement and checks for understanding.

7. Evaluation
Set questions or tasks that provide evidence of whether the stated objectives have been achieved.

OTHER NAMES YOU MAY SEE
Schools use different words for the same fields. Instructional objectives may be called **behavioural objectives** or **learning objectives**. Previous knowledge may be called **prior knowledge** or **entry behaviour**. The lesson presentation may be written as **steps**, beginning with an introduction (sometimes called **set induction**) and moving into the development of the lesson. Use the wording your school requires.

FROM GOALS TO PREPARATION

Make the objectives clear and teachable

3. Instructional objectives

An objective should describe an action learners can demonstrate. Avoid vague statements such as “learners will understand plants” unless you explain what understanding will look like.

WEAK OBJECTIVE
Learners will know the parts of a plant.

STRONGER OBJECTIVE
By the end of the lesson, learners will identify at least four parts of a flowering plant.

Useful action verbs include: identify, list, describe, explain, compare, classify, solve, demonstrate and construct. Choose a verb that matches the level of learning you expect.

A SIMPLE OBJECTIVE CHECK
Can you observe or assess the action? Is it appropriate for the learners’ level? Can it reasonably be achieved within the lesson time?

4. Instructional materials

Select materials that directly support the objective and the way learners will encounter the content. These may include real objects, charts, pictures, models, textbooks, worksheets, digital resources or locally available materials. Check that they are suitable, safe and ready before the lesson.

5. Previous knowledge

Previous knowledge is what learners already know or have experienced that can help them connect with the new topic. It should relate directly to the lesson. Write it as something specific, for example “Learners can name common plants and say what plants need to grow,” rather than only “learners know plants.” A short question at the start can check whether your assumption is correct.

EXAMPLE: PARTS OF A PLANT
A teacher may ask: “Can you name any part of a plant?” or “What do plants need to grow?” The responses help the teacher identify what learners already know and where explanation should begin.

Connect the objective to the evaluation

If the objective says learners will identify at least four parts of a plant, the evaluation should ask them to identify those parts. If the objective requires learners to explain a function, the evaluation should ask them to explain a function. The assessment should test the learning that was actually planned.

TEACHING, PARTICIPATION AND EVIDENCE

Plan what the teacher and learners will do

6. Lesson presentation / teaching and learning activities

This section describes how the lesson will unfold. It should show more than the topic headings: include the teacher's actions, the learners' activities, the resources used and opportunities to check understanding.

Introduction	Introduce the topic, gain attention and connect to relevant previous knowledge.
Development	Explain or demonstrate the main ideas in a logical sequence, using suitable methods and materials.
Learner participation	Give learners opportunities to answer, observe, discuss, practise, solve, create or demonstrate.
Reinforcement and summary	Address misconceptions, reinforce important ideas and summarise the key learning.

MAKE LEARNER PARTICIPATION VISIBLE

Instead of writing only "teacher explains the parts of a plant", add what learners will do: observe a plant diagram, label the roots, stem, leaves and flower, and explain one function.

7. Evaluation

Evaluation helps the teacher gather evidence of learning. Use questions, practical tasks, written responses, demonstrations or other suitable activities that match the objectives.

Example — Parts of a Plant

- Name four parts of a flowering plant.
- What is one function of the roots?
- Which part usually makes food for the plant?

Evaluation is not simply about asking many questions. It is about finding out what learners can demonstrate and using the evidence to decide what needs to be reinforced or retaught.

Other sections your school may require

Depending on the prescribed format, a lesson note may also have separate headings for conclusion, assignment or follow-up activity, references or instructional sources, teacher reflection, and other administrative details. These may be integrated into broader sections in some formats and listed separately in others. Follow your institution's requirements. The complete guide shows how to write each of these.

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

Your lesson note quick-check

Before submitting or teaching with your lesson note, review your preparation. Tick each box on screen, or print this page.

- [ ] I have entered the correct class, subject and lesson information.
- [ ] The topic and sub-topic are clear and appropriately focused.
- [ ] My objectives describe observable learner outcomes.
- [ ] The objectives are realistic for the learners and lesson time.
- [ ] The materials are relevant, suitable and ready to use.
- [ ] I have identified relevant previous knowledge.
- [ ] The teaching sequence is logical and manageable.
- [ ] Learners have meaningful opportunities to participate and practise.
- [ ] My evaluation tasks match the stated objectives.
- [ ] I have included any additional sections required by my school.

READY TO DEVELOP YOUR LESSON-PLANNING SKILLS FURTHER?

Knowing the components is only the beginning.

The complete Jeneconk guide, **How to Write a Lesson Note: A Practical Guide to Planning, Teaching, and Checking Learning**, takes you beyond the basics with detailed instruction, worked lesson examples, reusable templates, practical exercises, answer guidance and strategies for real classroom situations.

- Detailed chapters on objectives, resources, lesson sequence, evaluation, feedback and assignments
- Worked lesson notes for Primary Mathematics, English Language, Basic Science and Social Studies, plus a planning lab
- Reusable planning templates and a practice workbook with answer guide
- Ways to adapt lessons for different learners and low-resource classrooms
- Guidance on using AI responsibly, and on correcting common lesson-note mistakes

GET THE COMPLETE GUIDE

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